

# A Data Visualization of the Napoleonic Wars 🇫🇷

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**Napoleon Bonaparte** (1769 - 1821) always viewed himself as an underdog. Bullied in his youth, this resulted in a fierce **determination** and **ambition** as an adult.



“If I have any ambition, it is so natural to me, so innate, so intimately linked with my existence that it is like the blood that circulates in my veins.”

“Ambition is never content, even on the summit of greatness.”





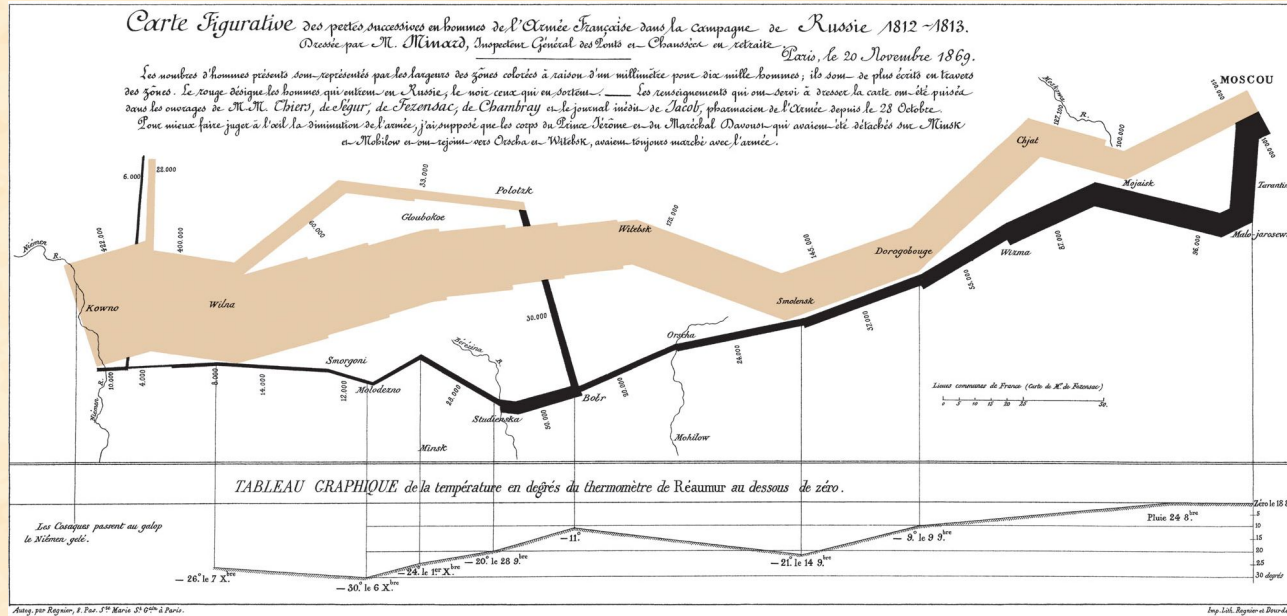
# The Napoleonic Wars



**Seven** coalitions of European powers tried to defeat France. Napoleon beat the first **five**.

- **1st (1792–97)** — France survives; Napoleon makes his name in Italy.
- **2nd (1798–1802)** — He returns from Egypt, seizes power, wins peace.
- **3rd (1805)** — Loses at sea (Trafalgar), wins big on land at **Austerlitz**. **Austerlitz** is Napoleon's *magnum opus*.
- **4th (1806–07)** — Crushes Prussia and Russia; rules most of Europe.
- **5th (1809)** — Beats Austria again, but looks weaker.
- **6th (1812–14)** — **Russia ruins him**; allies take Paris; exiled to Elba.
- **7th (1815)** — Escapes, rules 100 days, loses at Waterloo, exiled for good.

# Charles Joseph Minard's Data Visualization (1869)



**Six** variables in one graph:

- Army size
- Direction
- Longitude
- Latitude
- Time
- Temperature

“... may well be the best statistical graph ever drawn.” - **Edward Tufte** (American Statistician)



# DEMO

Link:

[napoleonic-wars-eta.vercel.app](https://napoleonic-wars-eta.vercel.app)

Github Repo:

<https://github.com/yli12313/Napoleonic-Wars-2026>

Q: Determination and ambition is often viewed as “good.” But what about the costs when it crosses into pride and preserving one’s ego?

